

IFPI Learning Platform

Administrator User Guide · Complete first-time walkthrough · Updated 12 August 2026

Version 4.0 · August 2026 — Complete first-time walkthrough

This is a step-by-step manual for administrators and instructors of the International Fitness Professionals Institute learning platform. It assumes no prior knowledge. Every instruction refers to the exact button and menu names you will see on screen.

1. Before You Start — Key Concepts

Term	What it means
Academy / Organization	Your own private tenant. Everything you create (courses, learners, certificates) belongs to your academy and is invisible to other academies.
Admin	Full control: authoring, learners, billing, settings.
Instructor	Authoring and learner management, no org-level settings.
Learner	A student. Self-registered accounts are always learners.
Course	A sequence of slides a learner plays through.
Exam	An assessment attached to a course. Passing it issues a certificate.
Exam gate	When a course has a published exam, learners must finish every slide before the exam unlocks.
Attempt	One sitting of an exam. Each exam has a maximum attempt count you control — and you can reset a learner's attempts if they run out.

Cohort	A label you attach to a group of invited learners so you can track them together.
Entitlement	The record that says "this learner may access this course" (via payment, free enrolment or a comp role).
Featured	Courses you star appear first in the marketplace's Featured row and on the public landing page.
PUBLISHED / DRAFT	Learners only ever see PUBLISHED courses and exams.

The sidebar. After logging in as admin you will see a left sidebar with: *Dashboard, Courses, Learning Paths, Exams, Certificates, Cert. audit, Leaderboard, Badge tiers, Reports, Marketplace analytics, Scheduled reports, Live sessions, Email diagnostics, Affiliate, Query builder, Users, Email Outbox, Feedback, Billing, Settings, Audit log, Webhooks, Deliveries, ERP360, Entitlements, Content imports, Deep research, API tokens, Academies, Public Catalog* — plus a **Help & guides** link at the bottom that opens this manual as a PDF at any time.

2. Logging In for the First Time

1. Open the platform URL in Chrome, Edge, Firefox or Safari.
2. Enter the admin email and password you were given, and click **Sign in**.
3. **The Welcome Tour.** About a second after your first login, a short guided tour appears: a welcome card with a **Show me around** button. Click it to be walked through the six most important places (Dashboard, Courses, Exams & insights, the Feedback inbox, and the Report-an-issue button). Click **Skip tour** at any point to dismiss it. The tour shows **once per account** and never again.
4. **If you are redirected to a "Change password" screen:** this is normal — seeded admin accounts must set a fresh password on first login.
5. **If a 6-digit code is requested:** two-factor authentication is enabled for your account. Open your authenticator app and type the current code.
6. **Forgot your password?** Click **Forgot password** on the login page and follow the reset link that is emailed to you.

■ ■ If a full-screen **Terms & Conditions** dialog appears, read and click **Accept** — you cannot use the platform until you do. (You control this gate yourself; see Section 19.3.)

3. Day-One Setup (do this once, ~15 minutes)

When you first open **Dashboard** you will see an **onboarding board** — a checklist with a progress bar. Work through it in this order:

3.1 Brand your academy

1. Click **Settings**. You land on the **Branding & Certificates** tab.
2. Set your **academy name**, **description**, **logo** and **primary colour** — the learner interface adopts the colour immediately.
3. Fill in the certificate section: **accent colour**, **signature text** (e.g. "Jane Doe, Programme Director"), optional **signature image**, and **footer text**. Every certificate PDF inherits these.
4. Or pick a **Theme preset**: hover a preset card for **Preview** (renders a sample certificate without saving) and **Apply** (persists). You can also click **New preset** to save your own combination — custom presets get a "Custom" badge with **Edit** and **Delete** buttons.
5. Click **Save**.

3.2 Connect outbound email (recommended)

Without this the platform still works, but invitation/notification emails go to a stub (logged, not delivered).

1. Click **Email diagnostics** — the transport panel shows which route is active: per-tenant SMTP → system relay → bridge → stub.
2. To connect your own SMTP, enter host/port/username/password/from-address in **Settings** → **Branding & Certificates** (SMTP section) and Save.
3. Back in **Email diagnostics**, use **send test email** — you get an immediate SENT / STUB / FAILED result with the exact error if any.

■ Until email is connected you can always copy invitation links directly from the Users screen and send them by hand.

3.3 Publish your Terms & Conditions (optional)

See Section 19.3. Learners must then accept them at login.

3.4 Create your first course, invite your first learner

Covered in Sections 5 and 11. The onboarding board ticks itself off and disappears at 100%.

4. The Dashboard, Explained

- **Metric cards** — learners, active enrolments, completions, certificates.
- **Members Needing Action** — learners who are stalled, failing, or approaching a deadline, with the reason colour-coded. Your Monday to-do list; also emailed in the weekly digest.
- **Weekly chart** — enrolments per week for the last 12 weeks. Use the toggle in its corner to switch between **Enrolments** and **Completions**; hover any bar for the exact count.

- **Recent Activity** — the latest enrolments as they happen.
 - **Docs engagement tile** and the **onboarding board** (until complete).
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5. Creating a Course Manually

5.1 Create the shell

1. Click **Courses** → **New Course**.
2. Fill in: **title**, **description**, **category**, **duration (minutes)**, **passing score** (e.g. 70), and **price** (0 = free).
3. Save. The course is created in **DRAFT** — invisible to learners.

5.2 Add and edit slides

1. Open the course editor. The left rail lists slides; the main pane edits the selected slide.
2. Click **Add slide**, give it a title, write rich-text content. Repeat. Slides can also carry **video**, **image**, **audio**, **PDF** or **SCORM** media.
3. Drag slides in the left rail to reorder. Click **Save** often — every save creates a version snapshot.

5.3 Give it a cover photo (recommended)

Courses look far better in the catalog with a real photo:

1. In the editor sidebar find the **Cover image** field.
2. Easiest: click **Gallery** — a curated grid of 15 professional fitness photos (weights rack, personal training, yoga, spin, nutrition coaching, boxing...) opens. Click one; it fills the field instantly.
3. Alternatively paste any **image URL**, or click **Upload** to use your own photo (max 5MB).
4. A live preview appears — remove it with the **X** if you change your mind.
5. Click **Save**. The photo now shows on catalog cards, the landing page and your admin course grid.

5.4 Voice narration (optional)

Open the **narration** panel on a slide, choose a voice/model/language (tick **translate first** if needed), click **Generate**, listen, keep or regenerate. Learners get a play button on the slide.

5.5 Prerequisites, versions, publishing

- **Add prerequisite** (right rail) locks the course until another course is completed.
- The **history** icon lists dated version snapshots — select one and **Restore** to undo anything.
- Click **Publish** when ready; **Unpublish** hides it again without losing learner progress. **PPTX download** exports the course as PowerPoint.

6. Creating a Course with the AI Builder

1. Click **Courses** → **AI Builder**.
2. Describe what you want, e.g. *"A 6-slide beginner course on client onboarding for new gym instructors, professional tone, with a short quiz."*
3. Click **Generate** (~10–30 seconds), review the draft, regenerate if needed, then **Apply**. The course arrives in DRAFT.
4. Edit it like any manual course — add a cover photo from the Gallery, tweak slides, then **Publish**.

■ ■ AI generation consumes your academy's monthly AI budget (default \$200, adjustable in Settings). See Section 22 if generation fails.

7. Exams — Authoring, the Exam Gate & Attempts

7.1 Create an exam manually

Exams → **New Exam**: title, linked course, time limit, passing score, max attempts. Add multiple-choice and true/false questions with points, then set the exam to **published**.

7.2 Create an exam with AI

Exams → **AI Quiz**: pick the course, number of questions and question type; **Generate**; edit any question inline; save as a **New exam** or **Append** to an existing one.

7.3 What learners experience — the exam gate

When a course has a published exam, learners see an amber banner inside the course player: *"This course ends with an exam — pass [exam name] to earn your certificate."* The exam stays locked until **every slide is completed**; on the final slide the button reads **Take exam** and leads straight into it. Before starting, learners see the time limit, passing score and an **Attempts left** counter. Passing issues the certificate automatically and counts as a course completion (which learners can then rate — Section 10).

7.4 Reviewing attempts

On **Exams**, each exam card shows learner outcome chips (Passed / score / No attempts). Click into an exam's attempts view — it has two tabs:

- **Learners** — every learner's attempts, scores, pass/fail and dates.
- **Question insights** — see Section 8.

7.5 Resetting a learner's attempts

A learner who used every attempt is blocked from retrying — but you can give them a fresh start:

1. Open the exam's **Learners** tab and find the learner.
2. Click **Reset attempts**. A confirmation dialog — "*Reset exam attempts?*" — explains exactly what will happen.
3. Confirm. All of that learner's attempts on this exam are cleared, their attempt counter returns to zero, and they are **notified by email** automatically that they may try again.
4. The reset is recorded in the **Audit log**.

■ Certificates already earned are never removed by a reset — it only clears the attempt history so the learner can sit the exam again.

8. Exam Question Insights — Find What Learners Get Wrong

Open any exam and switch to the **Question insights** tab. This is your question-quality dashboard, built from every submitted attempt:

8.1 Miss-rate bars

Each question row shows how many learners answered, how many got it right, and a coloured **miss-rate bar**: red (50%+ missed), amber (25%+), green (under 25%). Rows are sorted **most-missed first**, so the problem questions are always at the top.

8.2 Distractor statistics

Expand a question to see the **answer distribution** — a bar per answer option showing exactly how many learners picked it:

- the correct option is marked with a green ✓;
- the most-picked *wrong* option carries a red **TOP DISTRACTOR** badge.

If most learners pick the same wrong answer, the question wording (or your course content) probably needs attention — that is exactly what this view is for.

8.3 Miss-rate alerts (automatic)

You don't have to keep checking. When a question's miss rate reaches **50% or more across at least 3 answers**, the platform automatically:

- sends an **in-app notification** and a **question miss alert email** to every instructor and admin in your academy;
- marks the question row with an **"author alerted"** chip so you can see at a glance which questions already fired.

Each question alerts **once** (no spam). When you edit the question the alert **re-arms**, so if the fix didn't work you'll be told again.

8.4 Fixing a question without losing history

Click **Edit** on any insight row. The edit dialog lets you change the question text, answer options, correct answer, points and explanation **in place** — the question keeps its identity, so past attempts and the statistics history stay linked. There's also an **Edit course content** link in the insights header that jumps straight to the course editor if the problem is the teaching material rather than the question.

8.5 Export the insights as CSV

Click **Export CSV** in the insights header to download the full table (question, answered/correct/missed counts, miss rate, per-option distribution) — ready for a spreadsheet or your quality-assurance file.

9. Flashcards, Mind Map & AI Knowledge Tools

- **Flashcards** — author cards manually or generate with AI; learners review them on a spaced-repetition schedule.
 - **Mind map** — a drag-to-arrange visual canvas of your courses; layout is saved per user.
 - **Deep research** — ingest source documents into your academy's private corpus; powers semantic search and AI Tutor citations.
 - **AI Tutor** (learner-facing) — answers learner questions from your content with citations. Personal data in questions is always redacted before AI processing. Nothing to configure.
 - **Query builder** — ask plain-English questions about your data ("how many learners completed each course this month?"); the AI writes a read-only SQL query and shows the results. SELECT-only, capped at 500 rows.
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10. Marketplace Presence: Featured Courses & Ratings

10.1 Star your best courses

On **Courses**, every card has a small **star button** (top-left of the cover). Click it to add the course to the **Featured row** of the public marketplace — starred courses appear first (the row is topped up with your most-enrolled courses so it never looks empty). Featured courses with photos also appear on the public landing page. Click the star again to remove.

10.2 Course ratings

When learners finish a course they are invited to rate it 1–5 stars on the completion screen. Average ratings appear as an amber star badge on catalog cards — social proof that builds trust with new visitors. Ratings are only possible after completion, and each learner's latest rating counts once.

11. The Feedback Inbox — Notes *and* Screenshots

Every logged-in user (admins and learners alike) has a floating **Report an issue** button in the bottom-right corner. They pick ■ Bug / ■ Idea / ■ Other, type a message, and can now **attach a screenshot** — either by choosing an image file or simply pasting one from the clipboard. The page they were on is captured automatically.

You review submissions under **Feedback** in the sidebar:

- newest first, with the sender's name/email, page and timestamp;
- items with a screenshot show a **thumbnail** — click it to open the full-size image in a new tab;
- click **Mark reviewed** to tick items off (or **Reopen** to undo);
- feedback is private to your academy.

This is the fastest way to run UAT or collect learner suggestions without leaving the platform: your testers' notes and screenshots all collect in one place.

12. Managing Learners

12.1 Users

Users lists everyone with role, cohort, activity and streak. Self-registered accounts are always learners; admin elevation is invite-only.

12.2 Invite one person

Users → **Invite user**: email, name, role → **Send invite**. If email is stubbed, copy the invite link from the UI and send it yourself.

12.3 Invite a whole group (bulk / cohort)

Bulk invite: upload a CSV or paste one email per line, choose the role, and type a **cohort** name (e.g. "Sept-2026-Intake"). A per-row result shows sent / already-exists / invalid.

12.4 Cohort tracking

Reports → **cohort progress** (CSV export included). Crossing your completion threshold (default 75%) fires a celebration — optionally to a Slack/Discord webhook — and features in the Monday digest.

13. Learning Paths

Learning Paths → **New path**: name it, add courses in order (Foundation → Intermediate → Advanced). Learners see their position; finishing one step unlocks the next.

14. Live Sessions

- **New session:** title, date/time, meeting URL (any provider), linked course, optional capacity, optional weekly/monthly **recurrence** with exception dates.
 - **RSVPs:** learners RSVP per occurrence or whole series; RSVPing to a session of a course they aren't enrolled in **auto-enrols** them.
 - **Attendance:** open the session → **Attendance** → tick attendees (bulk mark supported). Attendance certificates and confirmation emails are automatic.
 - **Calendar feeds:** learners subscribe via a personal ICS URL; **rotate secret** org-wide if a link leaks. Reminder emails go out automatically.
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15. Certificates & Transcripts

- **Issued automatically** on exam pass or qualifying attendance, branded per Section 3.1, with a QR code linking to public verification.
 - **Verify:** anyone with the link/QR can confirm authenticity — no account needed.
 - **Share cards:** every certificate has a branded public share page with a generated **preview image**, so pasting the link into LinkedIn, Twitter or WhatsApp shows a rich card with the learner's name and course — free marketing for your academy.
 - **Revoke** (Cert. audit): find the certificate, click **Revoke**, give a reason. The verify page shows invalid+reason, the PDF download is blocked, and the share page shows a REVOKED banner. **Unrevoke** restores it.
 - **Bulk operations:** multi-select bulk revoke, per-certificate revocation history drawer, and CSV export for auditors.
 - **Learner transcripts:** every learner can download their own **academic transcript PDF** (all courses, progress, exam results and certificates) from **My Certificates** → **Download PDF**, or print the on-screen version via **Printable transcript**. Useful when learners need proof of study for an employer — no admin action required.
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16. Gamification

- **Badge tiers** — create your own tiers (name, points threshold, icon); learners are promoted automatically.
 - **Leaderboard** — the org ranking learners also see.
 - **Streaks** — automatic daily streaks with "about to break" nudge emails to learners and a weekly top-5 digest to staff.
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17. Billing, Pricing & Payments

- **Price a course** in the editor (cents — 49900 = R499.00). Free courses enrol instantly; priced courses route through checkout.
 - **Test vs live**: test environments show a stub banner and run Stripe in test mode (card 4242 4242 4242 4242 — no real charges). Production connects live Stripe or the ERP360 billing bridge (debit orders).
 - **Entitlements**: access is governed by the entitlement layer, not the payment provider. The **Entitlements** inspector shows exactly why a learner does or doesn't have access — check it before assuming a bug.
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18. Marketing Tools

- **Public catalog & landing page** — published courses are listed publicly with SEO-friendly URLs, sitemap, social preview cards, cover photos, ratings, and the Featured strip. No setup needed.
 - **Marketplace** — opt in (Settings) to be discoverable by other academies' learners; **Marketplace analytics** shows views/clicks/conversions.
 - **Affiliate** — create referral codes (reward %, notes), copy the link (</register?ref=CODE>), track pending vs credited earnings. Self-referrals are blocked.
 - **Share cards** — certificates and courses both have share pages with rich social previews (Section 15).
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19. Reports & Analytics

- **Reports** — enrolment/completion/certificate reports with CSV export.
 - **Course funnel** and **slide drop-off** — find exactly where learners convert or abandon.
 - **Exam question insights** — per-question miss rates, distractor stats and CSV export (Section 8).
 - **Scheduled reports** — subscribe recipients to daily/weekly/monthly emails of four report kinds; **Run now** for an immediate send.
 - **Dashboard weekly chart** — Enrolments/Completions toggle (Section 4).
 - **Query builder** — ad-hoc questions (Section 9).
 - **Audit log** — searchable trail of every significant admin action (including question edits and attempt resets).
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20. Settings Reference

20.1 Branding & Certificates

Branding, certificate identity, theme presets (built-in + your own custom ones), SMTP, cohort celebration threshold/webhook, digest toggles, marketplace opt-in, monthly AI budget.

20.2 Security

Change password; enable TOTP two-factor (scan QR → confirm code → **save the recovery codes**).

20.3 Terms & Kiosk

Publish versioned T&Cs (acceptance ledger records who/when/IP; a new version re-prompts everyone).

Kiosk mode locks shared devices after inactivity with PIN unlock. **Feature flags** switch individual platform features on/off for your academy.

20.4 Documents

Upload reference documents; the dashboard tile tracks engagement.

21. Integrations

- **API tokens** — scoped, org-bound tokens for external systems.
- **Webhooks** — HMAC-signed events (enrolment completed, certificate issued/revoked, AI budget threshold...); **Deliveries** shows every attempt and retry.
- **ERP360** — per-academy SSO and billing bridge (super admin).
- **Content imports** — SCORM/xAPI/bulk imports with one-click rollback.

22. Troubleshooting

Problem	What to check, in order
Invitation email never arrived	1) Email diagnostics → transport (STUB?) 2) spam folder 3) copy the invite link from Users
Learner can't see a course	1) PUBLISHED? 2) Entitlements lookup 3) prerequisite incomplete?
Learner can't start the exam	The exam gate: every slide must be completed first — check their progress in Reports
Learner ran out of exam attempts	Exams → open the exam → Learners tab → Reset attempts (they're emailed automatically)

Learner can't log in	1) correct URL? 2) Forgot password 3) account active in Users?
"Question miss alert" email — what is it?	A question is being missed by 50%+ of learners. Open Exams → Question insights, review the distractor stats, and edit the question or course content
AI builder / quiz / tutor fails	1) monthly AI budget exhausted? 2) platform AI key balance — contact your operator
Certificate verify says invalid	revoked? Cert. audit → revocation history
Webhook not arriving	Deliveries → attempt log; endpoint must answer 2xx fast
Payment succeeded but no access	Entitlements lookup; check Outbox + provider dashboard
Rating button missing for a learner	ratings unlock only after full course completion
No feedback appearing	check the Feedback page — items are org-scoped; the widget is bottom-right on every logged-in page
Feedback screenshot won't upload	images only (PNG/JPG/WebP), max 5MB
The welcome tour won't show again	it runs once per account by design — it can be re-triggered by clearing the browser's site data
Still stuck? Note the page, exact time and what you clicked — or ask the user to send it via the Report an issue button (with a screenshot!) — then contact your platform operator.	

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